

George Penny

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Credit risk, analytics and AI leader with 10+ years' experience building underwriting strategies, decision engines, monitoring frameworks and data products across fintech and financial services. A hands-on builder with a track record of turning complex risk problems into scalable systems, policies and operating capabilities. Combines deep credit expertise with Python, SQL, APIs, automation and modern AI tooling, alongside experience leading teams and influencing Product, Engineering, Data, Risk and Finance stakeholders, senior executives and external investors.

Professional Experience



Pliant | Head of Risk Strategy & AI

April 2025 - Present | London

Lead credit risk strategy, decisioning, analytics and applied AI for a B2B expense management and corporate card platform, with a portfolio limit of approximately €200m. Responsible for building scalable underwriting and portfolio management capabilities while establishing the business's data science function.

- **Refinancing due diligence:** Supported the business through a new £100m debt-refinancing SPV, acting as the credit risk subject-matter expert and presenting credit strategy, model validation, portfolio performance and default outcomes to investors.
- **Credit decision engine:** Designed and built a credit decision engine that now automates approximately 50% of onboarding cases, improving throughput, underwriting capacity and turnaround times.
- **AI enablement:** Built tools that gather background research and evaluate credit information to pre-populate credit memos, allowing underwriters to begin with a structured, evidence-based assessment.
- **OCR agent:** Developed an AI/OCR workflow to extract and spread financial information from financial statements.
- **Early warning monitoring:** Implemented early-warning indicators and an AI agent connected to multiple data sources to monitor customers for adverse media and emerging credit risk signals.
- **Ongoing Financial health monitoring:** Updated the runway simulation used to monitor customer liquidity using open banking transaction data.
- **ECL methodology:** designed an individual exposure methodology for expected credit loss assessment and provisioning.
- **Data science leadership:** Set out the operating model and technical direction for the data science function and led the first hires.



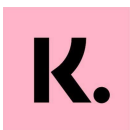
Stenn | Risk and Operations Lead

June 2024 - December 2024* | London

**Role concluded following administration*

A leader within the Product and Technology domain, reporting to the VP of Data and helping scale risk and operations strategy, automation and cross functional execution.

- **Automated decisioning:** Spearheaded the design and implementation of a decision engine that automated 7% of financing requests, representing approximately \$1m in monthly revenue and creating a scalable framework for growth.
- **Company OKRs:** Worked with the COO and functional leaders to define measurable company wide OKRs, track delivery and communicate progress through leadership reviews and town halls.
- **Risk governance:** Established and chaired the monthly Risk Committee and business performance reviews, aligning senior stakeholders on portfolio trends, strategic priorities and key initiatives.



Klarna | Senior Credit Risk Analyst

November 2021 - May 2024 | Berlin

Joined Klarna's Credit Risk Decisioning team, responsible for underwriting and portfolio performance across the Nordics, DACH, Netherlands and Belgium, covering approximately €2.7bn of monthly GMV.

- **Credit strategy optimisation:** Led analysis of underwriting inefficiencies and delivered policy rule changes, limit adjustments and new credit models to improve loss performance and support annual business targets.
- **Experimentation and bureau strategy:** Introduced champion-challenger and A/B testing approaches for third-party data providers. A German bureau test improved approval outcomes while reducing scoring costs by changing the primary and secondary bureau order. The test generated approximately £150k in monthly credit bureau savings while also reducing losses.
- **Swiss market launch:** Designed and built the initial go to market credit strategy for Switzerland, receiving an Employee of the Month nomination for the project.
- **Portfolio monitoring:** Developed management information dashboards and established bi-weekly reviews of market, merchant and product performance with cross functional stakeholders.



Equifax | Senior Credit Risk Analyst

May 2018 - October 2021 | London

Delivered bespoke analytics, modelling and credit risk solutions to banks and financial institutions across the credit lifecycle.

- **Single Customer View:** Developed a solution to identify the same customer across multiple portfolios, supporting customer aggregation and FSCS-related requirements. The solution initially generated approximately £40k in monthly revenue and led to an Employee of the Month award.
- **Credit risk modelling:** Built analytical samples and developed application scorecards using logistic regression, weight of evidence, information value and model-performance testing for banking and financial-institution clients, including a thin-file strategy for a start-up bank.
- **Creditworthiness Assessment Bill:** Provided evidence supporting Lord Bird's proposal to include rental data in credit assessments and received the London Employee of the Month award within the first three months.



AXA | Data Analyst

September 2015 - May 2018 | London

Built and maintained reporting infrastructure and analytical solutions to support data driven decision making.

- **Data infrastructure:** Used SAS, SQL and VBA to maintain complex data warehouses and deliver reliable datasets for internal teams and external clients.
- **Reporting and dashboards:** Designed KPI reporting and visual dashboards using Tableau and Power BI to improve performance monitoring across teams.

Personal Technical Projects

- **Applied AI engineering:** Completed a Udemy AI Engineering course and independently applied LLMs, RAG, agents and prompt engineering to practical business problems.
- **Personal RAG chatbot:** Built a RAG application using personal information from sources including LinkedIn, social media, CV and WhatsApp exports. Enabling natural language search and question answering across a private knowledge base.
- **Full stack messaging application:** Built an instant messaging application inspired by WhatsApp, using a React front end and REST API backend, with authentication, conversations and real time messaging functionality.

Education

University of Sussex | BSc Mathematics, First-Class Honours | 2012 - 2015

A Levels: Further Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Psychology (B)

Skills and Qualifications

Credit Risk: Credit policy, underwriting strategy, decision engines, application scorecards, portfolio monitoring, early-warning indicators, risk appetite, credit-limit strategy, ECL, loss provisioning and model validation

Modelling and Machine Learning: Logistic regression, linear regression, gradient boosting, XGBoost, weight of evidence, information value, feature engineering, model calibration, SHAP and explainability

Model Evaluation and Monitoring: AUC, Gini, KS, PSI, precision, recall, F1 score, confusion matrices, stability analysis, back testing and performance monitoring

Experimentation: Champion challenger strategies, A/B testing, randomised treatments, incremental staged rollout and outcome evaluation

Technology: Python, SQL, SAS, R, Git, REST APIs, LLMs, RAG, AI agents, OCR and React

Analytics and BI: Looker, Tableau, Power BI, Qlik Sense and Datadog

Leadership and Governance: Team building, hiring, credit committees, investor due diligence, executive presentations, cross-functional delivery, model governance and OKRs

Personal Training:

Udemy; Complete AI Engineering | Score Plus; Building Better Scorecards | Impact Factory; Presentation Skills